conservatives, while among the general public, this balance is nearly reversed," the Pew Research Center wrote in a wide-ranging 2013 survey of American Jewry.[5] These numbers have stayed remarkably consistent across the generations: 72 per cent of American Jews aged 65 and up identified as Democrats, as did 75 per cent of those aged 18 to 29. Apart from the Orthodox, not a single Jewish demographic group votes Republican.

The occupation was once thought to be a temporary phenomenon, particularly during the heady days of the 1990s, the era of the Oslo Accords, which allowed many in the diaspora to believe that it would end after a few years of negotiations. But the Oslo process went nowhere, and eventually led to the second intifada—four years of gruesome suicide bombings that silenced any talk of a negotiated agreement.

The years that followed 2005 cannot be classified so easily, but can perhaps best be described as a sort of lost decade. On the one hand, they embodied a time of relative peace and prosperity for Israel. Despite four wars against militant groups in Gaza and Lebanon, and a sustained wave of stabbings and hit-and-run attacks, overall violence went down. The Israeli economy thrived, at least on a macro level. The Palestinian Authority had recently been taken over by Mahmoud Abbas, a man who, for his many flaws, is firmly committed to nonviolence. Israel forged relationships with new allies in Asia and Africa—and even in the Middle East, where a mutual fear of Iran brought the Gulf monarchies into a quiet cooperation with their onetime foe.

Yet the decade also marked a time of diplomatic drift and inaction. Although the contours of a two-state solution are widely understood, countless attempts at diplomacy ended in failure. The last round of peace talks collapsed in 2014. At the time of writing, between Netanyahu's right-wing government and the Palestinians' intractable internal divisions, progress seems highly unlikely—despite Donald Trump's efforts. Hence the angst. How can one be both a liberal and a Zionist, when the latter seems to mean supporting a permanent occupation?

A fluttering flag

Israel had to do its own soul-searching about Zionism during the 2015 campaign. Zionism is the animating ideology of Israel, quite literally the state's *raison d'être*. It originated in Europe in the late nineteenth century as